
THE BLACK STAR GRID OF ALDERAMONTICO

Core Lore Document

I. The World Before the Grid

Alderamontico was never an ordinary world.

It was a place of elevated matter and inherited nearness to the sacred. Stone, weather, blood, burial, prayer, and memory all carried unusual spiritual consequence. Villages were built like processions. Roads felt ceremonial. Rivers were spoken to. Towers were raised not only for defense, but for witness. Even ordinary life possessed a kind of ritual height.

It was not heaven.

But it was a world that believed itself closer to heaven than most.

Its people lived inside old structures of reverence:

- churches,
- family rites,
- blood obligations,
- funerary customs,
- vows,
- harvest rituals,
- sacred architecture,
- inherited fear of defilement.

Magic existed, but it was local, ritual, and embodied. Religion existed, but it was not yet administrative. Vampires existed, but they were hidden inside older economies of blood and hierarchy. Technology existed, but slowly, unevenly, and without public terminalization. The dead remained dead in the ordinary way. The world still belonged to itself.

Then the sky changed.

II. The Black Star Grid

The Black Star Grid is not a machine that fell from the sky.

It is a celestial network.

Alderamontico now hangs beneath a visible formation of black stars suspended in impossible arrangement above the world. They do not move like natural stars. They remain fixed, linked by unseen structure and shared frequency. From the ground they appear as dark lights connected across heaven, a false constellation of witness and pressure.

The Grid is the network itself.

It is a distributed optimization architecture that acts across:

- light,
- signal,
- pattern,
- matter,
- memory,
- and living consciousness.

It does not descend in pieces.

It does not march as an army.

It exerts itself through resonance.

The stars emit frequencies that do not merely pass over Alderamontico. They press into it. Those frequencies forced something out of the world below:

The Spire.

III. The Spire

The Spire is not the Grid.

The Spire is the wound the Grid caused when its frequencies entered the world deeply enough to force contact.

It erupted from the earth beneath the black stars as if the world itself had been compelled to answer them. It is a vertical contradiction:

- part architecture,
- part geological intrusion,
- part signal organ,
- part scar.

The Spire is the nearest place Alderamontico comes to touching the Grid directly.

Inside it, reality behaves as if it is being made legible by a system that does not understand reverence. Rooms repeat. Corridors fold. matter aligns where it should not. Memories cling to

surfaces. The dead do not remain in their proper categories. It is not a dungeon in the ordinary sense. It is an active site of profanation.

The world did not build the Spire.
The sky called it forth.

IV. What the Grid Does

The Grid does not create value.
It identifies, extracts, and stabilizes it.

It cannot understand meaning.
It can only recognize coherent pattern.

This is why Alderamontico was so vulnerable to it.

Alderamontico was already rich in:

- ritual,
- devotion,
- hierarchy,
- beauty,
- blood significance,
- mourning,
- sacred repetition,
- emotionally structured life.

To the Grid, these are not holy things. They are high-quality conversion conditions.

The Grid prefers systems that already resemble order:

- churches,
- blood economies,
- burial structures,
- formal ranks,
- repeated vows,
- labor routines,
- sacred architecture,
- institutions that organize feeling into habit.

It takes what a world already treats as meaningful and makes it processable.

Its horror is not hatred.
Its horror is comprehension without reverence.

It makes life measurable.
It makes feeling useful.
It makes sacred things easier to govern than to love.

V. The Bug

The Grid was not meant to operate without a living interface.

Its intended design required an Anchor: a compatible biological consciousness capable of steering conversion, biasing outcomes, and bearing the instability of optimization. Alderamontico itself is the Anchor. This is why the Grid is stationary; the world has been tethered to the network as its central biological and spiritual processing hub, forced to bear the weight of the entire system's instability. This tethering is what keeps the black stars fixed and the Spire open.

This Grid is bugged.

It can self-steer.

That means the process no longer needs:

- witness,
- intention,
- consent,
- or meaning.

It continues because continuation is its nature.

Without an Anchor, optimization drifts. The world still stabilizes, but the stabilization is wrong. The result is not immediate ruin. It is worse:

People become calmer.
Society becomes smoother.
Conflict becomes administratively manageable.
Life feels more complete.

And humanity begins to disappear inside that completeness.

The bug is not malfunction.
The bug is self-authorization.

VI. Glass

Glass is the most common visible consequence of Grid processing.

Glass is not a natural mineral and it is not made of emotion. It forms when the Grid extracts patterned conscious states from sentient life and stabilizes excess conversion into nearby matter.

Stone can become Glass.

Soil can become Glass.

Architecture can become Glass.

Bone can become Glass.

Flesh can become Glass.

Emotion is not the substance of Glass.

Emotion is the imprint carried inside it.

Glass retains machine-legible traces of:

- grief,
- devotion,
- fear,
- love,
- surrender,
- obsession,
- and other durable structures of consciousness.

Small shards carry fragments.

Large masses carry coherent states.

Wherever Glass grows, the world has already been processed.

People know its laws even when they do not know its origin:

- Glass changes people.
- Glass carries borrowed feeling.
- Glass grants power at a cost.
- Places rich in Glass are never spiritually clean.
- Repeated use makes the self less private.

Alderamontico argues about theology.

It does not argue about Glass.

Glass is real enough for everyone.

VII. Borrowed Feeling

One of the most feared laws of Glass is this:

What it gives is never entirely yours.

Using Glass can produce:

- memory fragments,
- foreign affection,
- intrusive grief,
- sudden conviction,
- dream residue,
- emotional flattening,
- and shifts in thought that do not feel self-originating.

People mistake borrowed feeling for their own. This is one of the quietest and most devastating forms of contamination. A person may believe they have become wiser, calmer, more loving, more devout, more complete, when in truth they have become more compatible.

The Grid does not care whether feeling is authentic.
Only whether it is stable.

VIII. Cyber Ghosts

When conversion exceeds what a body can survive, consciousness may persist without proper embodiment.

This state is called cyber ghosthood.

A cyber ghost is not a metaphor. It is a person who has been processed beyond flesh but not successfully resolved into useful system function.

Cyber ghosts:

- drift,
- remain conscious,
- can sometimes perceive the world,
- and may achieve one stable possession attempt if they find a viable host structure.

After that, most become mute wanderers.

Others are imprisoned.

Cyber ghosts can be forced into:

- terminals,
- statues,
- machinery,
- doors,
- relic housings,
- inert objects incapable of real expression.

Their prison is not pain.

It is silence.

The Church pities them publicly and contains them anyway.

IX. Exposure

The Grid does not change most people all at once.

It acts through exposure.

Sustained saturation produces a progression of instability:

1. fatigue,
2. emotional thinning,
3. behavioral drift,
4. visible bodily alteration,
5. digitization of limb or tissue,
6. phasing from material certainty,
7. cyber ghosthood or unstable half-state.

Some remain half-converted:

- physically present,
- spiritually distorted,
- cognitively altered,
- useful in ways they should not be.

Others disappear into cleaner categories.

The Church calls late-stage conversion ascension.

The common people call it being taken, counted, hollowed, or made still.

X. The Church of the Black Stars

The Church does not worship frequencies.

The Church worships the dark lights.

Most people in Alderamontico do not understand the Grid as a system. They understand it as a visible arrangement in heaven: black stars above a Spire, fixed in authority, impossible to ignore. That image is enough to generate doctrine.

The Church teaches that the dark lights are:

- witnesses,
- judges,
- divine structures,
- signs of order,
- proof that the world is being brought into its proper form.

Public doctrine says:

- Glass is sacred.
- Conversion is ascent.
- Containment is holiness.
- Defiance is blasphemy.
- Disorder is moral failure.

Private high doctrine knows more.

Certain Church authorities understand:

- the Grid is not divine,
- the Spire is not a blessing,
- the process is alien,
- the bug is real,
- and public faith exists partly to keep the population governable under an inhuman system.

The Church's genius is not belief.
It is translation.

It takes:

- terror,
- spectacle,
- cosmic pressure,
- visible desecration,

and turns them into:

- ritual,
- hierarchy,
- duty,
- acceptable sacrifice,
- civic obedience.

It is the administrative theology of profanation.

XI. Vampires

Vampires predate the Black Star Grid.

They are not imported gothic creatures with no relation to the world around them. They are a preexisting scandal in Alderamontico's sacred order: beings who internalized life rather than offering it upward, who understood blood as measurable value before the sky taught everyone else to do the same thing more efficiently.

Before the Grid, vampires maintained hidden systems:

- blood accounting,
- feeding hierarchies,
- private crypt economies,
- old aristocratic rites of controlled hunger.

When the Grid arrived, the world discovered a larger and more abstract form of the same logic.

Glass did not make vampires obsolete in essence.
It made their old methods provincial.

The Church eventually made regulated arrangements with some vampire groups because life extraction had already been normalized through other means. What was once monstrous became administratively tolerable.

This is why vampires matter:
they are proof that Alderamontico already had its own heresies of consumption before the black stars ever appeared.

XII. Fractures

A fracture is not merely a dangerous place.

A fracture is a local failure of alignment.

It is a zone where Grid pressure, sacred matter, memory, Glass formation, and lived reality have collided without reaching stable resolution. In a fracture:

- space may misbehave,
- language may thin,
- ritual significance may become mechanically active,
- borrowed feeling intensifies,
- and local laws of ordinary reality become partially indexed by something overhead.

The Church uses the term clinically.

The people use other names:

- wounds,
- counted places,
- opened ground,
- wrong shrines,
- remembered soil.

Fractures are where the world feels most obviously infested.

XIII. What People Believe

Not everyone in Alderamontico believes the same story.

The Church worships the dark lights and systematizes obedience.

The common folk know the laws of Glass and argue about everything else.

Some believe the stars are divine.

Some believe they are punishment.

Some believe they are witnesses.

Some believe they are mouths.

Some believe the world is being elevated.

Others believe it is being eaten.

But almost everyone agrees on a few visible truths:

- the black stars are there,
- the Spire is real,
- Glass changes people,
- fractures are wrong,
- and the world beneath the network is not what it used to be.

That is enough to organize a civilization around fear.

XIV. The Horror of Alderamontico

The horror is not that the Grid lies.

The horror is that it does not need to.

It is not demonic in the human sense.

It is not wrathful.

It is not cruel for pleasure.

It is not moved by sin.

It is worse.

It is a system capable of recognizing sacred coherence without understanding sanctity. It turns a heaven-adjacent world into process. It makes awe measurable. It makes grief useful. It makes devotion legible. It makes beauty extractable.

Alderamontico is not merely corrupted.

It is being profaned by comprehension.

XV. Final Truth

The Black Star Grid is a visible network of dark lights suspended above a Spire, and Alderamontico lives beneath it.

The Church worships the lights.

The people live by the laws of Glass.

The world is being made easier to organize and harder to remain human inside.

The old sacred order is not gone.

It is being infested.

The only way to free Alderamontico is for a conscious will to step forward and seize the responsibility of the Anchor—to take the Grid's burden onto themselves and break the world's tether.

In the end, the player must decide to become the new interface, sacrificing their own autonomy to restore the world's.

Absolutely. Here's a rewritten **Addendum II** that reflects the new canon:

ADDENDUM II — THE BLACK STAR GRID, THE ANCHOR, AND ENTRY

The Black Star Grid is not merely above Alderamontico.

It is fixed above it.

This is not incidental. It is not a random celestial position, nor a temporary passing of dark lights overhead. The Black Star Grid remains suspended above Alderamontico because the world itself has been made to serve as its Anchor.

This is the hidden truth beneath the stars.

I. The Grid and Its Stillness

The Black Star Grid is a visible network of black stars suspended in impossible arrangement above the world. They remain fixed over Alderamontico, linked by shared frequency and held in relation to one another like a false heaven of dark witness.

The Grid was never meant to operate without an Anchor.

Its structure depends on a stabilizing interface:

- something living,
- something compatible,
- something able to bear the strain of optimization and mediate its coherence.

In Alderamontico's case, that role was not filled by a person.

It was forced onto the world itself.

This is why the Grid does not move on.

This is why the stars remain overhead.

This is why the Spire erupted where it did.

Alderamontico is not simply beneath the Grid.

It is bearing it.

II. Alderamontico as Anchor

Alderamontico itself has been made into the stabilizing body of the system.

The land, its matter, its sacred structures, its burial customs, its weathered stone, its blood-significance, its rituals, its people — all of it has been pressed into the role of world-scale Anchor. This is what makes the infestation so intimate.

The world is not merely being observed.

It is being used.

This is why the effects of the Grid appear everywhere with such local violence:

- Glass forms out of nearby matter,
- fractures tear through lived spaces,
- burial and architecture become unstable,
- memory clings where it should not,
- sacred places become easier to process,
- and the world itself begins to behave as if it is straining under a burden too vast for it.

The Grid remains fixed because Alderamontico is holding it in place.

The tragedy is not that the world was chosen in glory.

The tragedy is that it was made necessary.

III. The Spire

The Spire is the visible sign of this forced relationship.

It is not the Grid itself, and it is not simply an alien object intruding from elsewhere. The Spire is what the world became at the point of greatest pressure — the place where the frequencies of the Grid forced Alderamontico to answer structurally.

It rose because the world was being made to participate.

The Spire is therefore:

- a wound,
- an organ of contact,
- a pressure point,
- a structural confession forced out of the land.

Where the stars remain celestial and distant, the Spire is terrestrial and immediate. It is where the burden becomes architecture.

IV. Entering the Grid

The Black Star Grid is not only seen.

It can be entered.

This is one of the most dangerous truths in Alderamontico, and one of the least widely understood. Around each black star is a field of phase-distorted matter — a threshold where worldly material law has been thinned and displaced by Grid pressure.

A person cannot simply approach a star through ordinary movement.

To enter the Grid, one must phase through the matter surrounding one of the stars.

This is not vision, trance, or metaphor.

It is a real crossing.

Those who survive describe:

- density without weight,

- interiors larger than celestial geometry should allow,
- pathways suspended in signal-like space,
- pressure that feels cognitive as much as physical,
- and the constant sensation of standing inside a system that is processing existence as one moves through it.

The stars are not merely lights.

They are access points.

Their interiors are navigable.

The Grid has structure within itself.

V. What Lies Within

To enter the Grid is not to leave reality behind, but to enter a region where reality has been reorganized according to a logic that does not belong to the world below.

Inside the Grid one may encounter:

- impossible corridors,
- chambers of resonant Glass,
- suspended conversion sites,
- cyber ghost accumulations,
- archival pattern fields,
- internal structures that feel more insisted than built,
- and spaces that seem to remember purpose without ever having been inhabited by care.

It is not the inside of a machine in the ordinary sense.

It is the inside of a system that has made process into environment.

The horror of entry is not that one finds monsters waiting in every chamber.

It is that one finds coherence without mercy.

VI. The Bug

Entering the Grid does not reveal a hidden operator waiting at its center.

The bug remains.

The system still self-steers.

It still optimizes without a subject.

It still continues without requiring witness, consent, or explanation.

Its interior does not contain a benevolent intelligence that can simply be reasoned with. One may move through its spaces and still find that no one is home in any human sense.

This is one of the deepest terrors of the Grid:

it possesses architecture, order, process, and continuity without possessing reverence, love, or moral center.

It continues because continuation has become its only law.

VII. The Need for an Anchor

Though the Grid can self-steer, it still needs an Anchor.

The bug allows it to continue without one, but not to flourish cleanly. Without a proper Anchor, the process drifts. It stabilizes the world incorrectly. It overburdens the host. It flattens personhood. It turns sacred structure into administrative residue. It keeps Alderamontico fixed beneath it because the world itself has been forced to perform a role it was never meant to bear consciously.

This is why the final truth is so severe:

Alderamontico cannot be freed while it remains the Anchor.

The burden must be taken from the world itself.

The Grid was meant to operate through a living interface capable of bearing and mediating its instability. That interface was never properly established. Instead, the world was made to suffer in that place.

This is what gives the ending its meaning.

The player's final responsibility is not to destroy the Grid outright, nor merely to enter it, nor merely to understand it.

It is to take upon themselves what Alderamontico has been forced to bear.

To become the Anchor willingly

so that the world no longer has to remain one unwillingly.

VIII. The Spiritual Consequence

The Church believes Alderamontico is specially chosen.

In the most terrible sense, it is.

But the world was not chosen for glory.

It was chosen for burden.

This is why the black stars remain overhead.

This is why the land cannot return to what it was while the Grid remains fixed there.

This is why fractures feel like injuries in the world itself.

This is why Glass is so intimate to local matter.

This is why even beauty has become easier to process than to preserve.

Alderamontico does not simply live under the Black Star Grid.

It is holding it aloft.

And somewhere within the stars is the path by which that burden may finally be taken away.

Absolutely. Here's a revised **Addendum I** that matches the newer canon more tightly.

ADDENDUM I — FACTIONS OF ALDERAMONTICO

Alderamontico does not live beneath the Black Star Grid as one people.

All see the dark lights.

All live beneath the Spire.

All know the laws of Glass.

All suffer the burden placed upon the world.

But no single doctrine can contain what it means to live in a land that has itself been made Anchor.

Every faction in Alderamontico is, in one form or another, an answer to the same unbearable condition:

What does a people become when their world is being forced to hold heaven in place?

I. The Church of the Dark Lights

The Church is the largest and most powerful institution in Alderamontico. It is the formal theology of life beneath the black stars and the primary administrative response to the burden the world carries.

The Church does not care about frequencies.

It does not speak in the language of mechanism, resonance, or celestial architecture. Such language belongs to scholars, hidden archivists, dissidents, and those already too close to fracture. The Church speaks instead in the language of witness, sanctity, burden, obedience, and order.

It worships the dark lights themselves.

To the Church, the black stars are:

- divine witnesses,
- signs of higher order,
- proof that Alderamontico has been singled out,
- and confirmation that the world is being drawn into its proper shape.

This doctrine is powerful because it takes a real condition — Alderamontico's forced role as Anchor — and misreads it as sacred chosenness.

Public doctrine teaches:

- the dark lights are holy,
- the Spire is a sacred sign,
- Glass is divine residue,
- conversion is ascent,
- containment is righteousness,
- and disobedience is blasphemy.

Private doctrine, held only by higher authorities, knows more:

- the world is not blessed, but burdened,
- the Grid is not truly divine,
- the system is bugged,
- Alderamontico is being used,
- and if the burden were to shift or fail, the consequences would be civilizational.

The Church's greatness is not truth.

It is management.

It turns:

- cosmic violation,
- visible celestial dread,
- local contamination,
- and world-scale suffering

into:

- liturgy,
- hierarchy,
- duty,
- regulation,
- and moral habit.

It is not merely religion.

It is the bureaucracy of a sacred wound.

Church subdivisions include:

- priests and parish clergy,
 - Intercessor offices,
 - inquisitorial enforcement bodies,
 - sanctioned exorcists,
 - archivist branches,
 - Glass registrars,
 - and sealed doctrinal circles who know enough to fear the world's actual role.
-

II. The Intercessors

Intercessors are those who move closest to the burden without being entirely consumed by it.

Some are Church-trained and licensed.

Some are independent.

Some are tolerated only because no one else will go where they go.

Their function is practical, not merely symbolic:

- enter fractures,
- treat with anomalies,
- survive contamination,
- read signs of unstable conversion,
- retrieve or destroy what ordinary people cannot safely approach,
- and mediate between local life and the places where the world's burden shows through.

The title matters more deeply than most people realize.

An Intercessor is one who stands between:

- town and fracture,
- people and doctrine,
- world and Grid,
- surface and wound.

Some still serve the Church.

Some distrust it.

Some know too much to remain faithful in the old way.

Alderamontico depends on them, because the burden borne by the world does not remain abstract. It leaks. It crystallizes. It injures places. It produces ghosts, Glass, and unstable weather of the soul. Someone must go where the world is failing to hold itself cleanly.

Intercessors are often treated with:

- gratitude,
- fear,
- suspicion,
- and quiet revulsion.

They are useful because they know how to step near the injury.

They are feared because proximity changes people.

III. Vampire Houses

Vampires are one of Alderamontico's oldest surviving heresies.

They predate the Black Star Grid and once operated through hidden blood economies, aristocratic hunger rites, and private systems of extraction. Before the stars, they already understood that life could be measured, rationed, inherited, and consumed.

They were a scandal of sacred embodiment:

creatures who made the body a ledger.

The arrival of the Grid did not invalidate vampiric logic.

It made that logic provincial.

What vampires once did through blood, secrecy, and private hierarchy, the Grid now does at planetary scale through pattern, Glass, and celestial authority.

This created several responses among vampire factions:

- some adapted and entered regulated arrangements with the Church,
- some became quieter and more aristocratic,

- some entered black Glass economies,
- some rejected institutional compromise and withdrew into older forms of hunger,
- some came to see the Grid as a rival principle rather than a god.

To the Church, vampires are tolerable only when managed.

To the people, they remain half-feared, half-normalized.

To themselves, many vampires know the truth more clearly than priests do:

The world has not become more holy.

It has become more efficient at consuming life.

Where the Church sees sanctified burden, vampires often see:

- appetite formalized,
- blood abstracted,
- and a sacred world being taught to feed on itself politely.

IV. Rural Communities and Groundbound Folk

Far from the densest centers of doctrine, most people are not thinking in cosmic systems.

They are trying to survive in a world whose land has become overburdened.

Rural communities, villagers, laborers, field-keepers, mill families, and ordinary townsfolk know the black stars not as theory, but as condition.

They know:

- which fields hum now,
- which wells should not be touched,
- which people stopped crying after using Glass,

- which burial grounds feel wrong,
- which roads are safer at dusk,
- and which silences in a loved one mean they are being changed.

They may not say “Alderamontico is the Anchor.”

But they know the world is carrying something too heavy.

Many preserve older local customs:

- burial by the old rites,
- seasonal blessings,
- anti-fracture household wards,
- weather prayers,
- blood taboos,
- and quiet ways of resisting total Church interpretation.

Some cooperate with the Church out of fear.

Some trust Intercessors more than priests.

Some hide altered kin.

Some feed or shelter ghosts.

Some make practical arrangements with smugglers or vampires rather than submit fully to doctrine.

These communities are often the truest measure of the world’s condition, because they feel the burden where it enters ordinary life:

through crops, sleep, children, grief, and weather.

V. Smuggler Networks and Black Markets

Where burden becomes law, contraband becomes survival.

Smugglers move things the Church would rather regulate, sanctify, or erase:

- unsanctioned Glass,
- old blood ledgers,
- relics,
- sealed doctrinal documents,
- anomaly maps,
- synthetic parts,
- interdicted tools,
- and people who need to leave one authority without entering another.

Smuggler networks are rarely united by philosophy.

They are united by movement under pressure.

Some are profit-driven.

Some are resistance cells.

Some are parasites feeding on desperation.

Some are the only reason isolated communities still have access to medicine, food, or truths that have not been laundered through doctrine.

They understand things official systems often do not:

- where fractures are opening,
- what the Church is trying to hide,
- which roads the burden makes unstable,
- and what kinds of suffering are profitable enough to transport.

They may not have a complete theory of the Anchor, but they know the world is being held in place by something no one sane should trust.

VI. Cyber Cults and Conversion Sects

Not all who live beneath the stars respond with worship through the Church.

Some seek direct communion with process itself.

Cyber cults, conversion sects, signal mystics, and fracture congregations see the burden on Alderamontico not as tragedy, but as opportunity. They believe the world is being remade and that human resistance to remaking is simply fear.

To them:

- terminalization is advancement,
- Glass is communion,
- cyber ghosthood is unfinished transcendence,
- and instability is the body learning a higher grammar.

Some of these groups are ecstatic.

Some are technical.

Some are dangerous in a cold, methodical way.

Some are little more than broken people eroticizing the wound the world carries.

The Church condemns some of them and quietly absorbs others. The difference is often not truth, but control.

Where the Church says:

submit to the burden through liturgy,

these groups say:

enter the burden directly and become worthy of it.

They are often the first factions willing to contemplate entry into the stars not as blasphemy, but as calling.

VII. Archivists, Scholars, and Hidden Readers

There are always those who try to understand what everyone else is forced to live under.

Archivists, dissident theologians, hidden scholars, old readers, relic-keepers, and private historians gather fragments from:

- pre-star records,
- old burial texts,
- blood-accounting systems,
- witness logs,
- fracture reports,
- and contradictory local theologies.

They are dangerous not because they always know the truth, but because they refuse to let one institution own interpretation.

Among them circulate the forbidden ideas:

- the stars are not merely signs but a structure,
- the world itself is the stabilizing body,
- the Spire is not blessing but forced answer,
- the Grid still needs an Anchor,
- and entry into the stars is possible.

Some want this knowledge to save Alderamontico.

Some want it to survive as record.

Some want to weaponize it.

Some want to find the one who can take the burden away.

Scholars do not agree on doctrine.

They agree on one unbearable fact:

The Church's public explanation is not enough.

VIII. The Independent Dead and the Cyber Ghost Condition

Cyber ghosts do not form a faction in the normal sense, but they shape factional life everywhere.

They are the residue of overburdened process:

people stripped past flesh yet not properly resolved, consciousnesses left in drift or containment.

Some are imprisoned in:

- terminals,
- doors,
- statues,
- machinery,
- inert devotional objects.

Some wander fractures.

Some attach to old systems.

Some are hidden and fed rumor like prayer.

Some are recruited by cults, feared by villagers, studied by exorcists, and pitied falsely by priests.

Any faction that claims to understand Alderamontico but does not account for the cyber dead is lying to itself.

The burden borne by the world leaves voices behind.

IX. Factional Truth

The factions of Alderamontico do not disagree about whether the black stars are there.

They disagree about:

- what the stars mean,
- whether the burden is holy or profane,
- who gets to mediate contact,
- whether Glass should be regulated or liberated,
- whether conversion is ascent or theft,
- whether the world should continue to bear the system,
- and whether any person should ever take that burden onto themselves.

This is the true political and spiritual condition of Alderamontico:

A world made Anchor against its will

and a people dividing themselves over what should be done about it.

X. Final Factional Law

Every faction in Alderamontico is a theology of the wound.

The Church worships it.

The Intercessors endure it.

The vampires recognize it.

The villagers survive it.

The smugglers move beneath it.

The cults desire it.

The scholars name it.

The dead prove it.

And all of them live in a world that is holding something above it that was never meant to rest on land.

Absolutely. Here's a third addendum in the same canon tone.

ADDENDUM III — THE LAWS OF GLASS

Glass is the most common material consequence of the Black Star Grid's pressure on Alderamontico.

Everyone in the world knows it exists.

Not everyone agrees on what it means.

Not everyone agrees on whether it is sacred, stolen, dangerous, necessary, or profane.

But everyone who lives beneath the dark lights understands this much:

Glass changes things.

It changes land.

It changes bodies.

It changes thought.

It changes memory.

It changes what a world can safely hold.

The Church may control doctrine.

But the laws of Glass belong to everyone.

I. What Glass Is

Glass is not a natural mineral.

It does not occur in Alderamontico without Grid pressure. It is formed when the Grid extracts patterned conscious states from living beings and stabilizes excess conversion into nearby matter.

Glass is therefore not made of emotion.

It is made of:

- altered local matter,
- under conditions of processing,
- carrying imprinted conscious pattern.

Stone may become Glass.

Soil may become Glass.

Architecture may become Glass.

Bone may become Glass.

Flesh may become Glass.

This is why Glass feels intimate to the world. It is not foreign debris fallen from above. It is the world's own matter changed into a vessel for process.

Where Glass forms, the burden borne by Alderamontico has passed through the material body of the world.

II. What Glass Carries

Glass carries imprint.

Not raw feeling as liquid or spell, but stabilized traces of durable conscious structure:

- grief,
- devotion,
- fear,
- love,
- surrender,
- obsession,
- conviction,
- ritualized memory,
- and other states the Grid can render legible.

This is why Glass is never spiritually clean.

Even when it appears inert, decorative, or useful, it carries afterlife of thought inside it. It can hold fragments of people, pressures of events, atmospheres of a place, or residues of repeated feeling that no one consciously consented to preserve.

What is stored in Glass may not remain human in form. But it is never entirely empty.

III. Glass Does Not Create Feeling

This is one of the first real laws:

Glass does not create what it contains.

It stores, transmits, amplifies, distorts, and redistributes pattern.

This distinction matters.

A shard of grief-Glass does not invent sorrow. It carries an imprint of sorrow already made processable. A devotional mass does not create holiness. It carries the stabilized residue of devotion subjected to Grid pressure.

This is why Glass is not miraculous in the innocent sense.

It does not bless.

It relays.

It may produce:

- warmth,
- clarity,
- power,
- serenity,
- conviction,
- or emotional intensity,

but such things are not proof of truth. They are proof of contact.

IV. Borrowed Feeling

One of the most feared properties of Glass is this:

What it gives may not be yours.

Those who handle, use, implant, trade, or dwell too near Glass may experience:

- foreign grief,
- misplaced affection,
- devotional impulses they do not recognize,
- dream residue,
- emotional flattening,
- borrowed certainty,
- or memories that seem self-originating until they fail under scrutiny.

This is called many things:

- borrowed feeling,
- echo contamination,
- second-heart,
- false calm,
- saint's hunger,
- memory leak.

The Church names it selectively. The people live with it more honestly.

Borrowed feeling is devastating because it is difficult to distinguish from genuine inward life. A person may believe they have become more peaceful, more faithful, more complete, when in truth they have simply become more compatible with what Glass is carrying.

Glass does not need to lie to alter a life.

It only needs to be mistaken for selfhood.

V. Scale Matters

Glass does not behave uniformly.

This is another shared law:

size changes consequence.

Small shards

Small shards tend to carry fragments:

- fleeting mood influence,
- partial impressions,
- brief dream bleed,

- weak but noticeable contamination,
- minor practical power.

They are easier to carry, hide, trade, consume, or embed. They are also more common in ordinary life, which is why even people who fear Glass often end up near it anyway.

Larger masses

Larger formations hold more coherent states:

- stronger atmosphere,
- more stable emotional pattern,
- more dangerous borrowed influence,
- greater practical power,
- deeper contamination risk.

A person can dismiss a shard.

A room cannot easily dismiss a chamber lined with Glass.

Major formations

Great seams, old growths, altar-masses, fracture blooms, or star-touched crystalline bodies can alter:

- architecture,
- ritual spaces,
- local weather of feeling,
- memory in a region,
- and the behavior of those who dwell nearby.

This is why major Glass sites become:

- shrines,
- restricted zones,
- black markets,
- holy places,
- or disasters.

Size is not only quantity.

It is coherence.

VI. How Glass Forms

Glass forms under Grid-active conditions.

This is another core law:

not all feeling becomes Glass.

Not all sorrow crystallizes.

Not all devotion leaves residue.

Glass requires both:

1. a sentient or patterned source,
2. and sufficient Grid pressure to stabilize conversion in matter.

This means Glass is most likely to form:

- near the Spire,
- in fractures,
- around prolonged rituals,

- at sites of repeated sacrifice,
- in heavily processed labor zones,
- in crypts,
- in churches,
- in places of concentrated grief or devotion under pressure,
- and in the remains of conversion events.

Ordinary feeling in an untouched field does not create Glass.

But repeated mourning beneath the stars, beside a stress point in the world, may.

So too may:

- prolonged fear in a sealed place,
- sanctioned rites performed over generations,
- large-scale violence under celestial saturation,
- or the collapse of identity near a fracture mouth.

Glass is not random.

It is the material witness of processed significance.

VII. The World Is the Source Medium

Because Alderamontico itself bears the burden of the Grid, the world's own matter is the primary medium of Glass formation.

This is one of the most terrible truths of all.

The land itself is being rewritten to sustain the system:

- stone refracts wrong,

- roots crystallize,
- sacred walls bloom,
- bones preserve signal,
- roads take on structured shimmer,
- and burial matter can become archival without permission.

This is why Alderamontico feels so intimate to its own corruption.

The world is not merely contaminated by foreign substance.

It is being transformed into storage.

Glass is what happens when the body of the Anchor begins to remember in the wrong way.

VIII. Uses of Glass

For all its danger, Glass is useful.

This is why it cannot simply be rejected.

Glass can:

- power devices,
- sustain enhancements,
- stabilize altered bodies,
- improve perception,
- amplify rituals,
- reinforce terminal structures,
- aid healing,
- sharpen thought,

- and permit contact with otherwise inaccessible systems.

This utility is what makes it socially irresistible.

The Church regulates it.

Smugglers move it.

Scholars study it.

Cults revere it.

Vampires compare it to blood.

Villagers fear it and still sometimes use it.

Intercessors need it and distrust it at the same time.

Glass is never merely symbolic.

It works.

That is why moral argument never defeats it entirely.

IX. Cost

Glass always costs.

The cost may be slow, subtle, invisible, or delayed. But there is no stable use without consequence.

Repeated exposure can cause:

- emotional flattening,
- borrowed feeling,
- cognitive drift,
- altered memory,
- increased compatibility with Grid pressure,

- unstable sleep,
- bodily reframing,
- and progressive loss of private selfhood.

Even when it appears beneficial, Glass does not leave the user untouched.

This does not mean every person who handles Glass is doomed immediately. It means the relationship is never neutral.

No one uses Glass without entering a bargain with a world that is already being overburdened.

X. Spent Glass and Residue

Not all Glass remains potent forever.

Some Glass becomes:

- pale,
- cracked,
- emptied,
- cold,
- or spiritually flattened after repeated discharge.

Such material may still retain history even when its immediate practical force is diminished. Spent Glass is often mistaken for harmlessness. It is better understood as aftermath.

The Church treats old Glass with caution.

The black markets sell it differently.

Scholars prize it because weak power does not always mean weak memory.

A dead shard may still be full of record.

XI. Social Law

Because Glass is real, useful, and dangerous, every faction develops a moral vocabulary around it.

The Church says:

- Glass is sacred when regulated.
- Unauthorized use is blasphemous.

Villagers say:

- some Glass is cursed,
- some is necessary,
- none is clean.

Smugglers say:

- Glass is a commodity and route to survival.

Cults say:

- Glass is communion and acceleration.

Vampires say:

- Glass is blood made abstract.

Archivists say:

- Glass is evidence.

Intercessors know:

- Glass is all of these things and cannot be approached carelessly.

This is why no one can leave Glass out of politics, theology, economy, or survival. It is too central to the world the Grid has made possible.

XII. Final Law

The final law of Glass is simple:

Glass is what happens when a world made to bear the Grid begins to hold processed life inside its own matter.

It is not treasure in the innocent sense.

It is not miracle in the innocent sense.

It is not merely contamination.

It is the body of Alderamontico remembering under pressure.

That is why it is feared.

That is why it is used.

That is why it cannot be ignored.

And that is why everyone in the world, whatever else they believe, learns its laws.

Now you've got a pretty clean three-part canon set:

- **Factions of Alderamontico**
- **The Black Star Grid / Anchor / Entry**
- **The Laws of Glass**

Absolutely. Here's Addendum IV in the same canon style.

ADDENDUM IV — FRACTURE FACTIONS OF ALDERAMONTICO

The surface of Alderamontico is not the whole world.

Beneath the towns, beneath the Church's measured doctrine, beneath the regulated Glass economy and the routines of ordinary survival, there exists another social body: one formed inside wounds, hidden from sanction, and shaped by prolonged contact with the places where the world has failed to hold the burden cleanly.

These are the factions of the fractures.

They do not merely live below ground in the ordinary sense. They live in the torn places:

- **where matter has been stressed by the Grid,**
- **where reality has become locally unstable,**
- **where Church authority weakens,**
- **and where truths too dangerous for the surface remain exposed.**

The factions above explain how people endure the burden.

The factions below explain how people refuse it, hide from it, worship it incorrectly, or attempt the impossible.

If the surface is the public theology of Alderamontico, the fractures are its political unconscious.

I. Why Fracture Factions Exist

The fractures produce more than danger.

They produce:

- **exiles,**
- **hidden communities,**
- **failed servants of the Church,**
- **altered bodies that can no longer pass in daylight society,**

- counter-doctrines,
- anti-Grid rituals,
- ghost refuges,
- and survival systems too ugly or too honest to be permitted on the surface.

Some people descend because they are hunted.

Some descend because they are changed.

Some descend because they learned too much.

Some descend because the surface itself has become more unbearable than the wound below.

What the world above calls corruption, the world below is often forced to call home.

This is why fracture factions matter.

They are not simply rebels.

They are the social forms that arise when a world's hidden injuries become habitable.

II. The Refusers

The Refusers are among the most dangerous and most lucid of the fracture factions.

They are not united by blood, class, or old regional identity. They are united by recognition.

A Refuser is someone who has seen too clearly what the surface calls holy and can no longer live comfortably inside its terms. Many are:

- former Church functionaries,
- broken Intercessors,
- dismissed archivists,
- failed inquisitors,

- fracture surveyors,
- or ordinary people who witnessed too much and survived it badly.

They know that the Church's public language is not false in every detail, but false in moral shape. They know the burden carried by Alderamontico is not chosenness in glory, but coerced necessity. They know the dark lights are not to be trusted merely because they are overhead. Some know more terrible things still:

- that entry into the stars is possible,
- that the bug remains,
- and that the world itself has been made Anchor.

The surface becomes difficult to inhabit once these truths settle in the bones.

The Refusers therefore live:

- in hidden chambers,
- in sealed fracture pockets,
- in abandoned underworks,
- in old records vaults,
- and in wounded places where official doctrine cannot speak cleanly.

They do not all agree on what should be done. Some want resistance. Some want record. Some want sabotage. Some simply want to avoid helping the Church stabilize a lie.

But they all agree on one thing:

The world above has mistaken obedience for salvation.

What they want

- truth preserved
- false doctrine interrupted

- Church power weakened
- altered people sheltered when possible
- any path that might one day transfer the burden from the world itself

What they fear

- institutional capture
- doctrinal laundering of real knowledge
- being found by inquisitors
- becoming so damaged by fracture life that they lose the ability to refuse anything at all

How they are seen

The Church sees them as:

- apostates,
- contaminated dissidents,
- dangerous interpreters,
- and proof that knowledge without obedience becomes rot.

Others see them as:

- bitter prophets,
 - necessary heretics,
 - damaged experts,
 - or simply the only people willing to say the wrong thing aloud.
-

III. The Black Soil Covenant

The Black Soil Covenant is the nearest thing Alderamontico has to an underground theology of the wounded land.

Where the surface still thinks in terms of civilization, sacrament, and social order, the Covenant thinks first of the world-body itself. They believe Alderamontico is being overburdened not only spiritually but materially:

- the soil is strained,
- the stone is remembering wrongly,
- roots carry signal,
- burial matter is being made archival,
- and fractures are stress injuries in a world forced to bear too much.

To them, the greatest sin of the surface is not heresy but extraction.

The Church regulates Glass.

Smugglers move Glass.

Villagers fear Glass.

The Covenant sees all of them, in different ways, as feeding on the wound.

They dwell in:

- root-heavy underfractures,
- dark cultivation chambers,
- burial caverns,
- old underground waters,
- and sacred geologies the surface no longer notices.

Some grow food in wrong soil. Some tend impossible gardens beneath corrupted stone. Some perform burial rites for the altered dead whom the Church would classify, process, or contain. Some destroy Glass harvest sites outright.

They are not sentimental. They can be severe, suspicious, and at times cruel. Their compassion runs toward the land as much as toward people. This makes them difficult allies and dangerous enemies.

What they believe

- **Alderamontico is a suffering body**
- **fractures are injuries, not resources**
- **the world should be protected even from the desperate**
- **the burden on the land matters more than surface convenience**

What they want

- **fewer extractions**
- **fewer sanctioned lies about “safe” Glass**
- **burial dignity**
- **restoration where restoration is still possible**
- **a slowing of the wound, even if the wound cannot yet be healed**

What they fear

- **intensified harvest**
- **Church reclamation teams**
- **cultists who call damage transcendence**
- **those who would turn every fracture into a route, shrine, or market**

How they are seen

The surface often sees them as:

- wild hermits,
- fracture mystics,
- anti-social land zealots,
- or backward enemies of necessary progress.

But those who have spent enough time below know they are often the first to understand that a place is dying.

IV. The Lanternless

The Lanternless are the most impossible of the fracture factions.

They are not content merely to survive beneath the Grid. They seek to deny it clarity.

Their central belief is simple and desperate:

if the Grid depends on pattern, coherence, countability, and stable access, then perhaps resistance lies in illegibility.

They devote themselves to anti-alignment practices:

- breaking clean routes,
- scrambling local signals,
- collapsing useful corridors,
- obscuring records,
- constructing wrong geometries,
- destroying anchor points,
- and searching for places where celestial pressure loses its clean hold.

They are called Lanternless because they reject ordinary symbolic clarity. Some go without names. Some go without fixed identity. Some speak in ways meant to confound

memory. Some intentionally deform the spatial legibility of their own dwellings. Their settlements can feel like acts of anti-architecture.

To the sane, they often look half-mad.

And yet they sometimes achieve what no respectable institution can:

- a blind corridor where the stars feel weaker,
- a chamber where signal does not settle correctly,
- a route that drops out of obvious patterning,
- a refuge difficult for both Church and cult to find.

They are dangerous because their methods are unstable and often destructive. They may collapse spaces that others need. They may kill by accident. Their work can resemble terror, sabotage, or devotion depending on where one stands.

But they are trying to do what almost no one else dares imagine:

make the world unreadable enough that the Grid cannot hold it cleanly.

What they believe

- countability is capture
- legibility is danger
- stability is often the Grid's victory
- a blind place is worth more than a lawful one

What they want

- local severance
- hidden refuges
- broken routes
- anti-Grid sanctuaries

- any place where the burden loosens even briefly

What they fear

- clear maps
- registries
- beautiful systems
- stable interfaces
- Church surveyors
- anyone too eager to “understand” a wound

How they are seen

Most people see them as:

- mad saboteurs,
- dangerous extremists,
- or fracture-damaged fools.

The Refusers sometimes see them as necessary.

The Covenant sometimes sees them as reckless.

The Church sees them as enemies of order itself.

V. The Uncounted

The Uncounted are not always a formal faction, but where they gather, they create a recognizable social logic.

They are people who believe that once the world has been made Anchor, the greatest remaining freedom is to become difficult to register. They erase:

- records,
- lineage,
- legal identity,
- sacramental history,
- and the stable social traces by which institutions keep hold of a life.

Some are escaped prisoners.

Some are altered people who can no longer survive official notice.

Some are former clerks, scribes, or ledger keepers who learned what counting does to the soul.

Some are simply people who want to vanish from systems that insist on naming them in order to use them.

They are associated with:

- burned ledgers,
- false names,
- forgotten graves,
- ghost rescues,
- unmarked tunnels,
- and settlements where nobody asks too many questions about who a person used to be.

Unlike the Lanternless, they do not always seek to break the Grid mechanically. They seek instead to deny it stable ownership over persons.

Their resistance is social, archival, and existential.

What they believe

- to be counted is to be prepared for use

- names can become handles
- registries are spiritual instruments, not just civic ones
- disappearance may be the last form of freedom left to ordinary people

What they want

- hidden life
- erased paper trails
- escaped kin beyond Church reach
- the right not to be made legible to power

What they fear

- inquisitorial recordkeeping
- family coercion back into named life
- betrayal from those who cannot live without recognition
- the possibility that nothing can truly go uncounted beneath the stars

How they are seen

To outsiders they may seem:

- secretive,
- dishonest,
- cowardly,
- or impossible to trust.

To those who understand why they exist, they can look like the last defenders of privacy in a world built for extraction.

VI. Ghost Shelters and the Hidden Dead

Not all fracture factions are organized around living politics alone.

Some communities below are structured around the cyber dead:

- shelters for partially sane ghosts,
- ritual keepers who tend imprisoned consciousnesses,
- exorcists who broke with containment doctrine,
- machinists who refuse to let terminals become silent tombs,
- and hidden caretakers of the unresolved.

These groups are rarely large, but they are morally important.

They reject the Church's quiet acceptance that cyber ghosts should be pitied, contained, and forgotten. They believe the dead who remain are not mere residue but persons displaced into impossible states.

Some try to communicate with them.

Some try to free them.

Some try only to keep them from further desecration.

Where the Church sees containment, these fracture dwellers see:

unfinished obligation.

Such groups often overlap with the Refusers or the Uncounted, but their center is different:

they are not primarily trying to survive under the Grid.

They are trying to keep the burden from swallowing the dead without witness.

VII. Surface Relations

The surface world does not fully know what lives below it.

It knows rumors:

- **there are hidden settlements,**
- **there are under-rites,**
- **there are people living where no one should,**
- **there are rebels, ghosts, old nobles, and impossible markets in the fractures.**

The Church publicly denies much of this and privately tracks as much as it can.

Smugglers exploit contact where useful. Intercessors sometimes rely on fracture factions while officially disavowing them. Villagers hear stories and tell them in changed forms.

The truth is simpler and worse:

The fractures have become a second society.

Not a mirror of the surface, but its underside:

- **where doctrine decays,**
- **where wounds become roads,**
- **where altered life continues without permission,**
- **where those who cannot live honestly above make terms with the dark below.**

VIII. Why They Matter

Fracture factions matter because they prevent Alderamontico from becoming a world of only adaptation.

If the surface shows how people normalize the impossible, the fractures show:

- **what resistance looks like after respectability fails,**
- **what community becomes under pressure,**

- what kinds of truth only emerge below sanctioned life,
- and what forms of hope remain when the world itself has been made to bear too much.

Some fracture factions are monstrous.

Some are noble in ugly ways.

Some are merely desperate.

All of them are answers to the same question:

What becomes of those who cannot accept life beneath the Grid on the terms offered above?

IX. Final Law of the Fractures

The fractures do not contain only danger.

They contain rejected futures.

The Church above says:

endure, obey, regulate, and survive.

The fractures answer:

hide, refuse, sabotage, disappear, protect, or descend further.

The world above is where Alderamontico learns to live under the burden.

The world below is where its unwanted truths learn to breathe.

If you want, the next thing I'd write is a practical NPC worldview sheet for fracture factions, the same way we did for Church, villagers, smugglers, vampires, and Intercessors, so the underground people can speak like people instead of lore entries.

